

***Eudaimonia* – the good life**



At the heart of Socrates's constant questioning was the question of how best we should live our lives. By trying to narrow down exactly what we mean by terms such as justice, virtue, honour and courage, he believed people could learn to behave in a way that was more just, virtuous, honourable or courageous, and live a good life. Of course, this in turn raised the question of what exactly we mean by living a 'good life', which the Greek philosophers called *eudaimonia*.

The search for a definition of *eudaimonia* and its attributes became a central concern of Greek moral philosophy. It seemed obvious that a 'good' life should be a happy one, but by happiness do we mean contentment, or sensual pleasure? And what sort of lifestyle would bring about most happiness? For Socrates, the good life was about more than pleasure and happiness, and included the very ideals he examined in such detail: justice, honour, courage and so on – all considered to be constituent parts of virtue, in its widest sense.